STORE MAP PLANNING GUIDE

How to plan the FBS Boise store, step by step. No tech skills needed.

WHAT YOU NEED

1. The link: **franklinmap-boise.com**
2. Your own code from AJ (it looks like **ABCD-EF23**). You use it once, to make your username and password.
3. A computer, a tablet or your phone

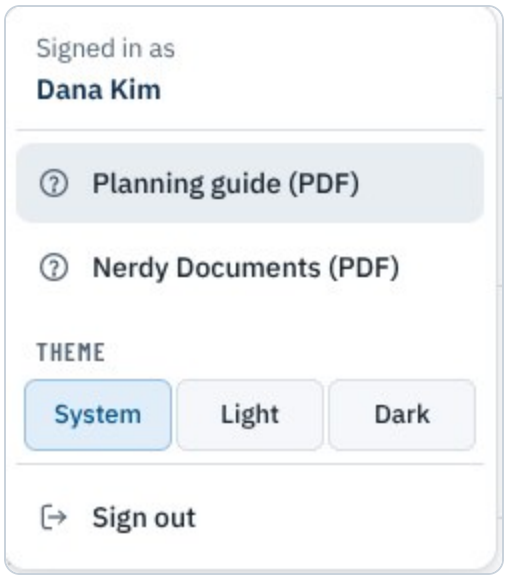
THE PLAN IN ONE LINE

Start your own plan → put the departments on the floor → fix anything red → check it with the Advisor → print it → send it to AJ.

FBS Boise Store Map · Planning Guide · October 2026. The screens may look a little different as the site improves.

WHAT'S INSIDE

1. Get in: make your profile, sign in, forgot your password
2. Find your way around the screen
3. Start your own plan
4. Put the departments on the floor (and the brand sections)
5. Red means “fix this”
6. Not sure where a product goes?
7. Add aisles, shelves and desks
8. Check your plan with the Advisor
9. Walk through it like a customer
10. Compare with today's store
11. Print it, save it as a PDF or email it
12. Send it to AJ
13. Using a phone
14. The 11 rules of a great layout
15. If something goes wrong



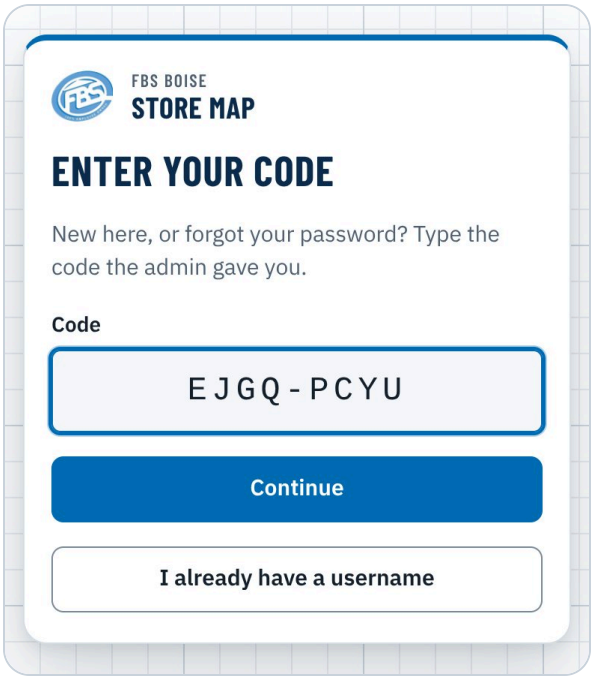
Where to find this guide: press your initials at the top right of the map (your **profile menu**). It has **Planning guide (PDF)** and **Nerdy Documents (PDF)**: how the site works behind the scenes and how your information is protected.

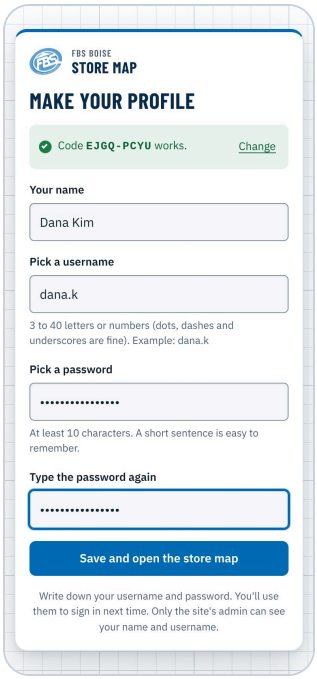
Good to know: you can't break anything. Your plan is yours alone: nobody else can change it, and it never changes the real store map until AJ approves it. Everything saves by itself, and **Undo** takes back any mistake.

1. GET IN

THE FIRST TIME: MAKE YOUR PROFILE

1. Open **franklinmap-boise.com**.
2. Type the code AJ gave you (like **ABCD-EF23**) and press **Continue**.
3. Type your **name**. Pick a **username** (like **dana.k**) and a **password** of at least 10 characters. A short sentence like **blue forklift 42** is easy to remember.
4. Type the password again and press **Save and open the store map**. That's it: the map opens.





Write your username and password down somewhere safe. The code works **once**; from now on you sign in with your username and password. The site never asks for your phone number.

1. GET IN (CONTINUED)

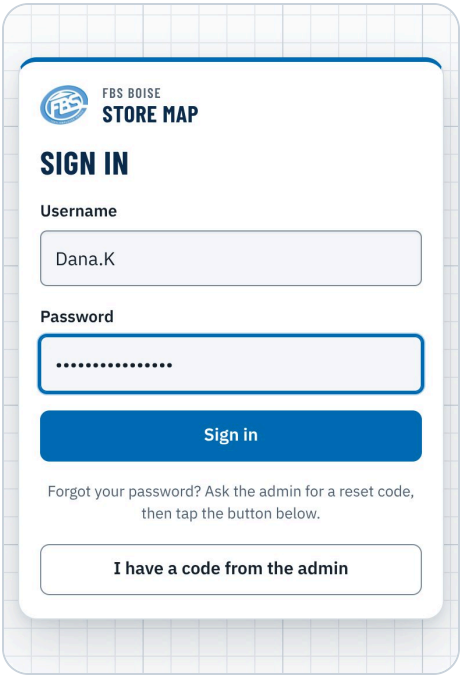
NEXT TIME: SIGN IN

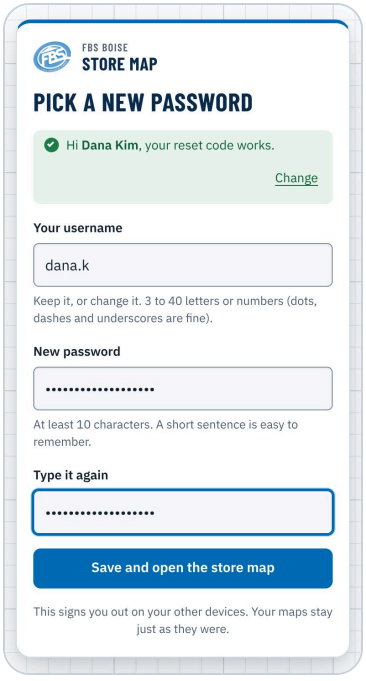
1. Open **franklinmap-boise.com**.
2. Type your **username** and **password** and press **Sign in**. (If you see *Enter your code* instead, press **I already have a username**.)

You stay signed in on that phone or computer for up to 90 days, as long as you come back at least once a month. On a new phone or computer, just sign in again.

FORGOT YOUR PASSWORD?

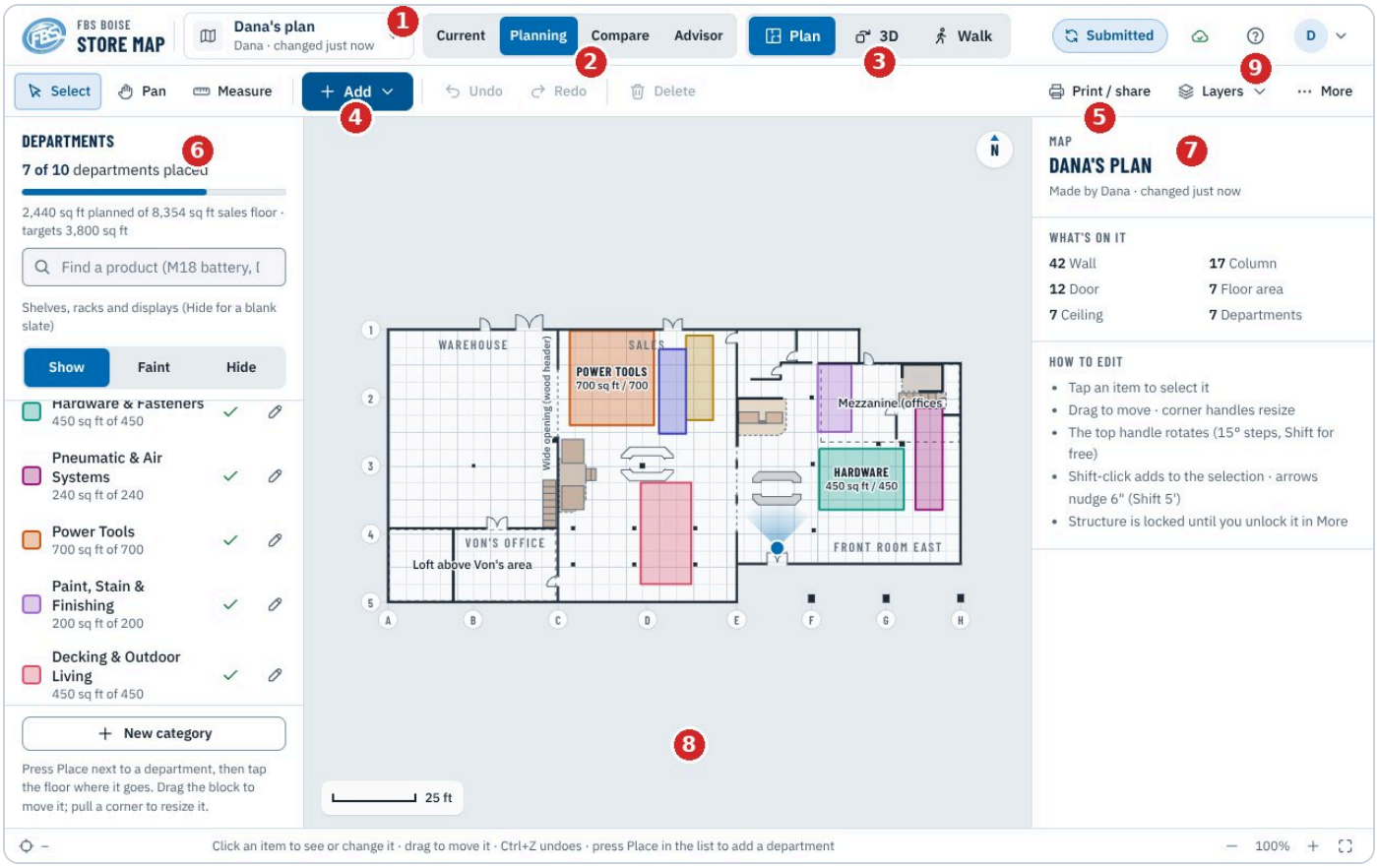
1. Ask AJ for a **reset code**.
2. On the sign-in page press **I have a code from the admin**, type the reset code and press **Continue**.
3. Your username is already filled in. Pick a new password, type it again and press **Save and open the store map**. Your maps are all still there.





2. FIND YOUR WAY AROUND

This is the planning screen. Here is what each part does.



1 **Which map you're on.** Tap it to switch maps or make a new one.

2 **What you're doing: Current** = the store today. **Planning** = where you plan. **Compare** = two layouts side by side. **Advisor** = tips and a score.

3 **How you look at it: Plan** = from above (best for planning), **3D** = the whole store, **Walk** = like a customer.

4 **Add** shelves, racks, displays, desks or a department.

5 **Print / share**: print the map, save it as a PDF or email it.

6 **Departments list.** Every department, how big it is and whether it's placed.

7 **Details.** Tap anything on the map to see its size and change it here.

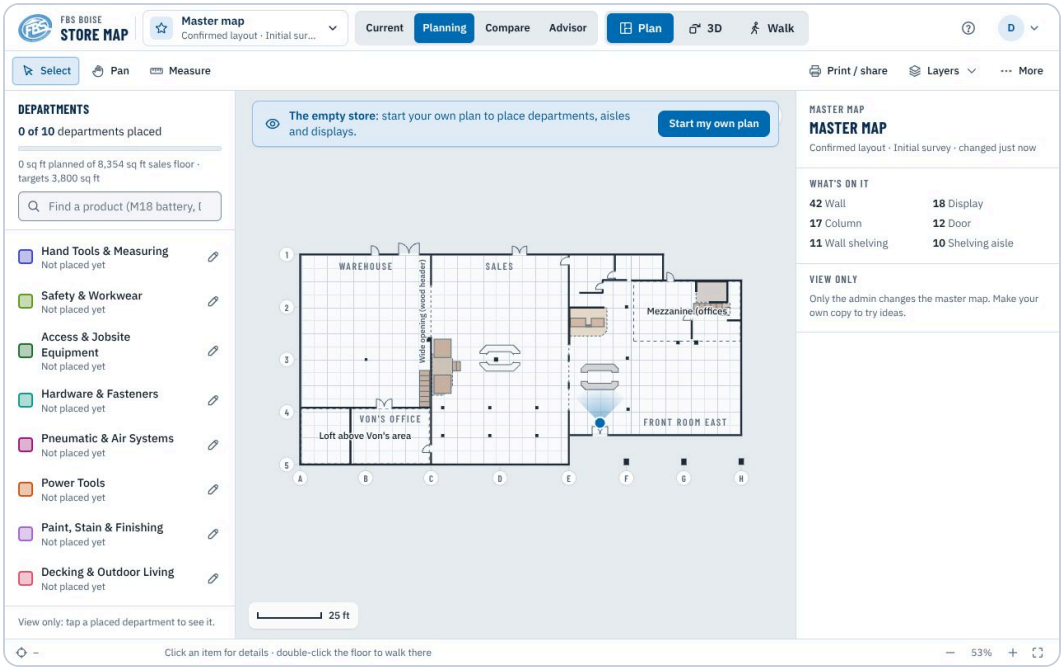
8 **The floor.** Drag empty floor to look around; scroll or pinch to zoom.

9 **Help.** The **?** button lists every control.

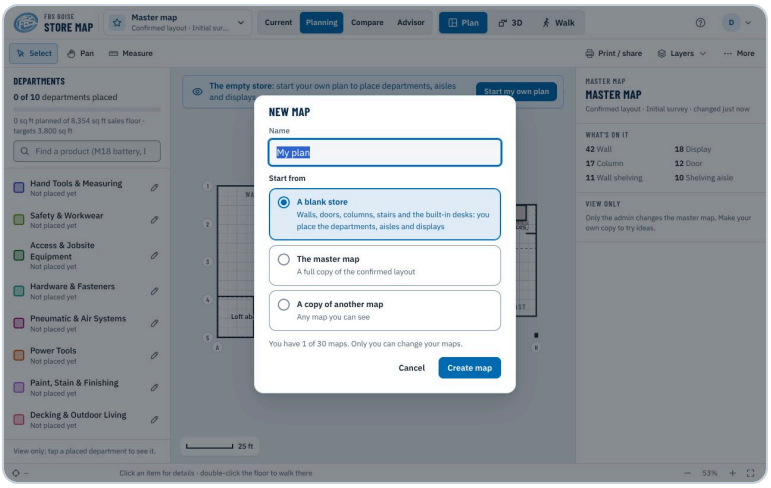
> **Shortcut keys** (on a computer): 1 Current · 2 Planning · 3 Compare · 4 Advisor · Ctrl+Z Undo.

3. START YOUR OWN PLAN

When you open the site you see the empty store: just the walls, doors, columns, stairs and the built-in desks. That is your blank sheet.



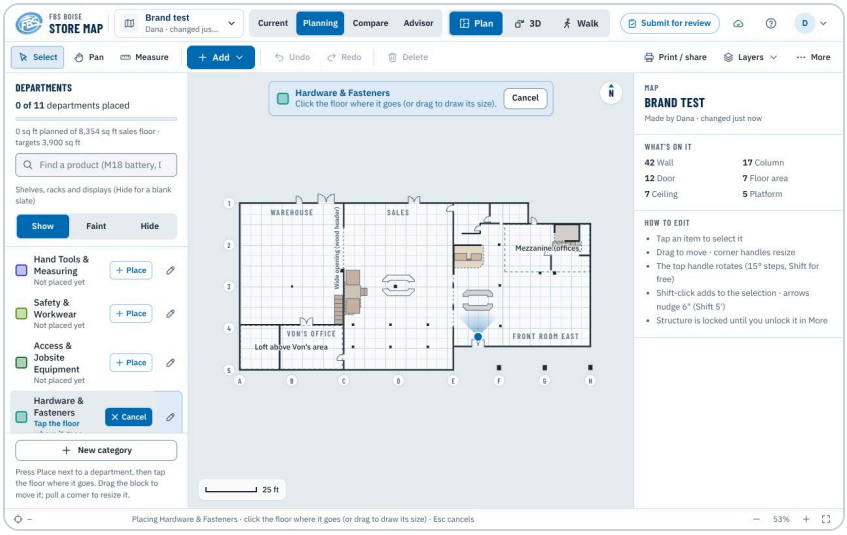
1. Press **Start my own plan** in the blue note at the top.
2. Leave **A blank store** picked, give your plan a name (like “Dana's plan”) and press **Create map**.
3. Your plan opens. It saves by itself every few seconds (the cloud with a tick at the top means it's saved).



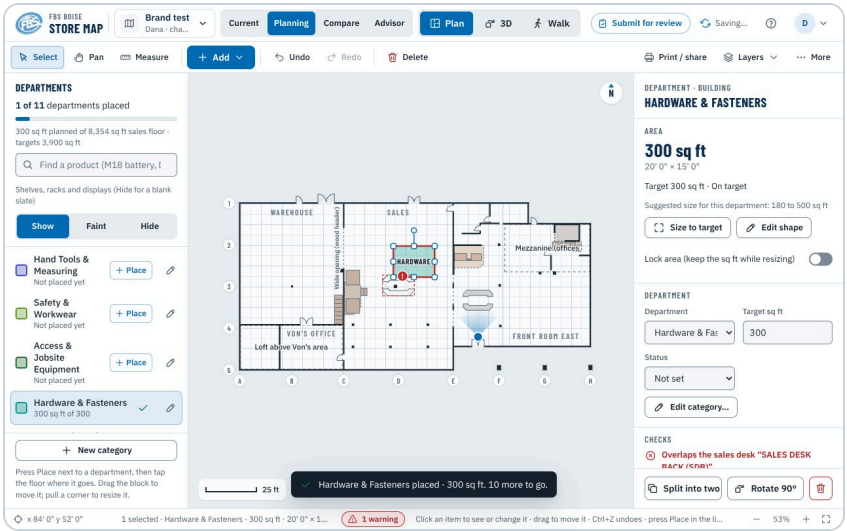
> Want to start from how the store is set up today instead? In the same box pick **The master map**. You can have up to 30 plans; switch between them with the map name at the top left.

4. PUT THE DEPARTMENTS ON THE FLOOR

1. In the **Departments** list on the left, press **+ Place** next to a department.
2. Click (or tap) the floor where it should go. It appears at its target size. *(Or drag on the floor to draw the exact size you want.)*
3. Drag the block to move it. Pull a corner to make it bigger or smaller. The round handle on top turns it.
4. On the right you see its size against the target. **Size to target** makes it exactly the right size.
5. Do the same for every department. The list shows how many are placed.



After pressing Place: the blue note at the top says what to do next. Press Cancel to stop.

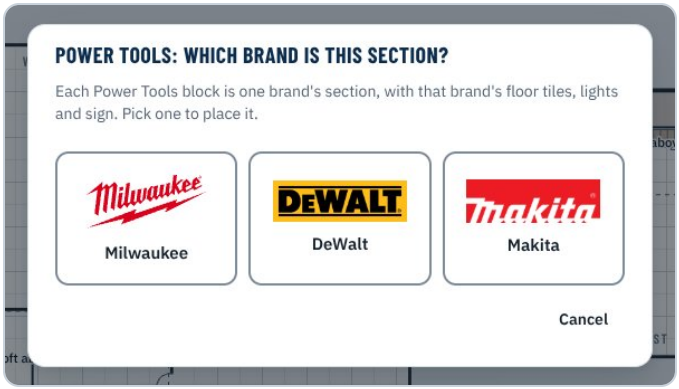


Placed: Hardware & Fasteners is 300 sq ft, on target. The red mark means it's touching something; see section 5.

4. BRAND SECTIONS

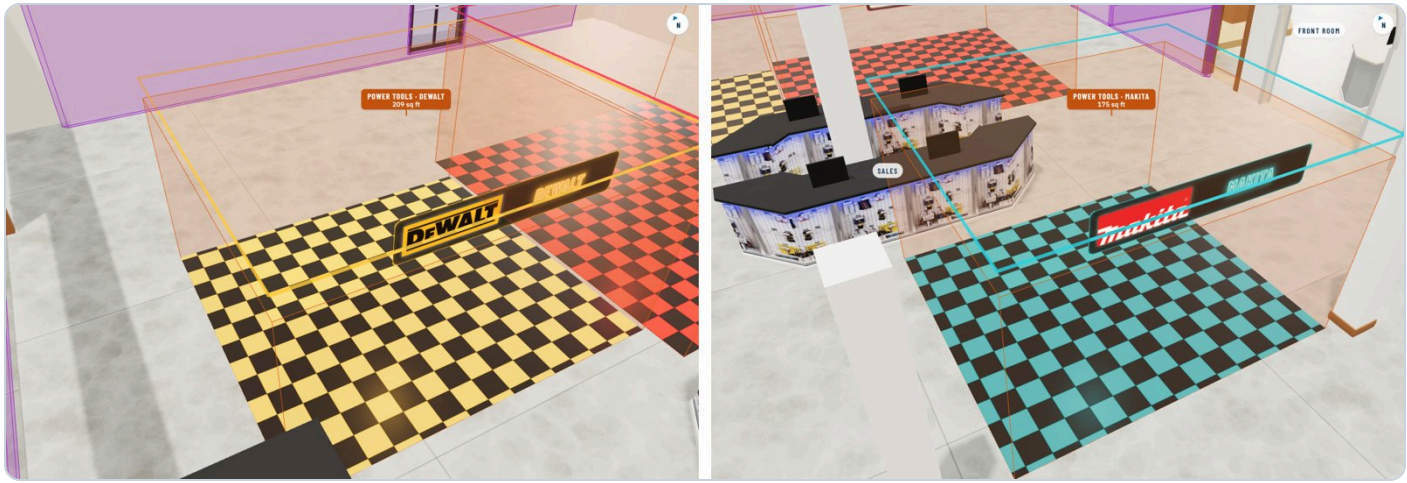
Power Tools is laid out by brand: one section each for **Milwaukee**, **DeWalt** and **Makita**. **Simpson Strong-Tie** is its own department.

1. Press **+ Place** next to **Power Tools**. A box asks *Which brand is this section?* Pick Milwaukee, DeWalt or Makita. (**Cancel** places nothing.)
2. Click the floor where that brand goes. The section starts at the brand's share of Power Tools: Milwaukee 45%, DeWalt 30%, Makita 25%.
3. Press **+ Place** next to Power Tools again for the next brand. The list says *1 of 3 brands* until all three are down.
4. **Simpson Strong-Tie**: press **+ Place** next to it like any other department. It's Simpson's, so there's no question.





Left: the brand question. Right: the three Power Tools sections and Simpson, each on its brand's floor tiles.



In 3D and Walk, each brand section gets 12" x 12" floor tiles in the brand's colours, a soft light in its colour and a neon sign with its name and logo.

> **Changed your mind?** Tap the section and change **Brand** on the right. The tiles, light and sign follow. A Power Tools block with no brand says *Pick a brand*.

5. RED MEANS “FIX THIS”

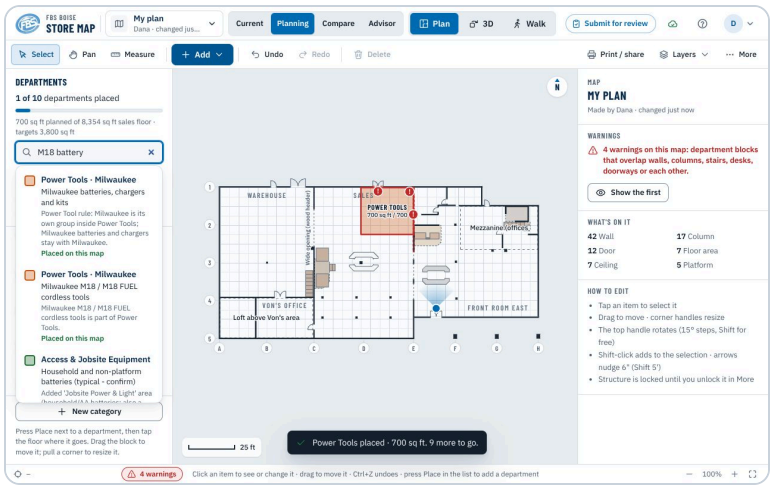
A department turns **red** when it sits on a wall, a column, the stairs, a desk, in front of a door, or on top of another department.

1. Look at the bottom of the screen: a red **4 warnings** button shows how many problems there are. Press it to jump to the first one.
2. The right-hand panel says why, under **Checks** (for example “Blocks the will call doors – keep 4 ft clear”).
3. Drag the block until the red goes away. Repeat until there are no warnings.

> Made a mess? Press **Undo** (or Ctrl+Z) as many times as you like. Deleted something by mistake? The message that pops up has an **Undo** button too.

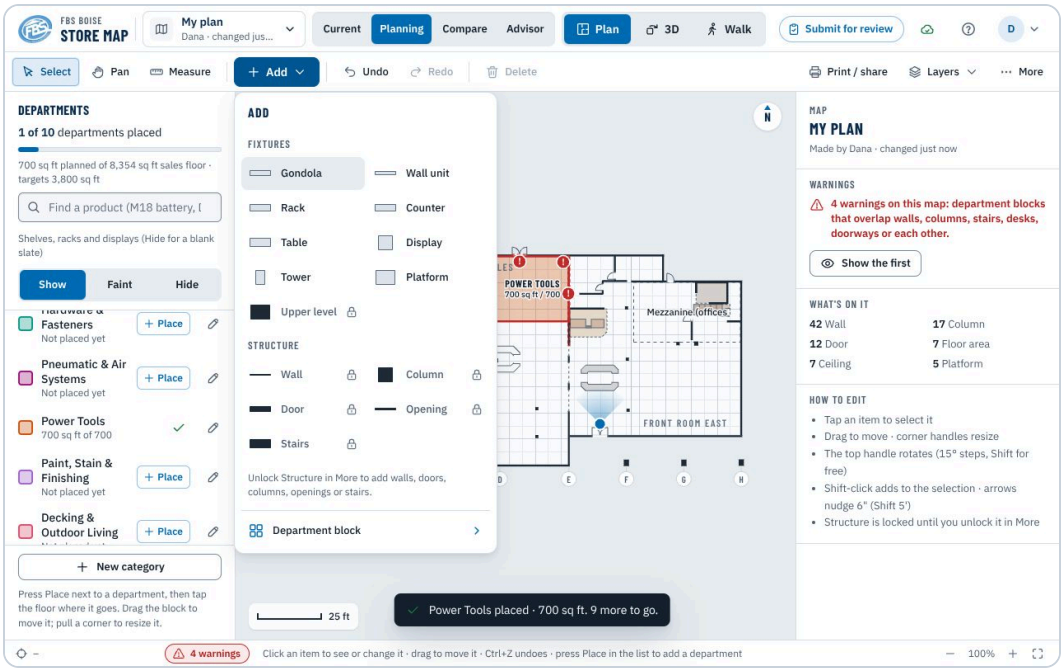
6. NOT SURE WHERE A PRODUCT GOES?

Type what you sell into **Find a product** at the top of the Departments list (like “M18 battery” or “Diablo blade”). It tells you which department it belongs to and why. Tap the answer to see that department on the map, or press **Place it** if it isn't on your map yet.



7. ADD AISLES, SHELVES AND DESKS

1. Press **Add** at the top.
2. Pick what you want: shelving (gondola), wall shelving, rack, counter, table, display, tower, platform...
3. It drops in the middle of what you're looking at. Drag it into place, then use the corners to size it.

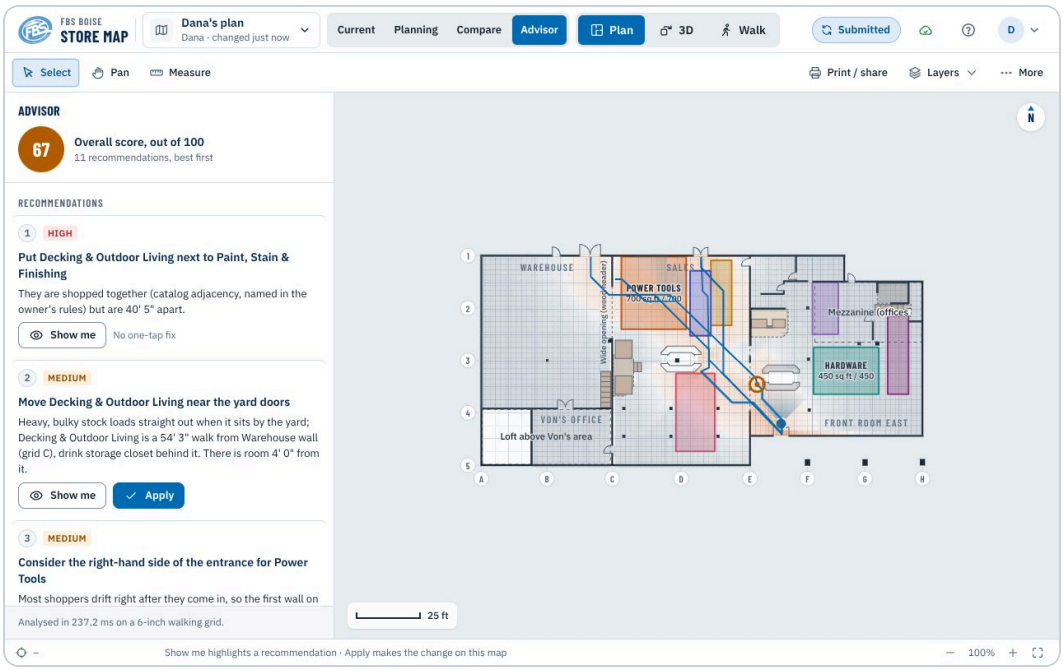


> Walls, doors, columns, floors and stairs are **locked** so they can't move by accident. To change one, go to **More** → **Structure locked** to unlock it. Lock it again when you're done.

8. CHECK YOUR PLAN WITH THE ADVISOR

The Advisor checks your plan against the rules of a good store layout and gives it a score out of 100.

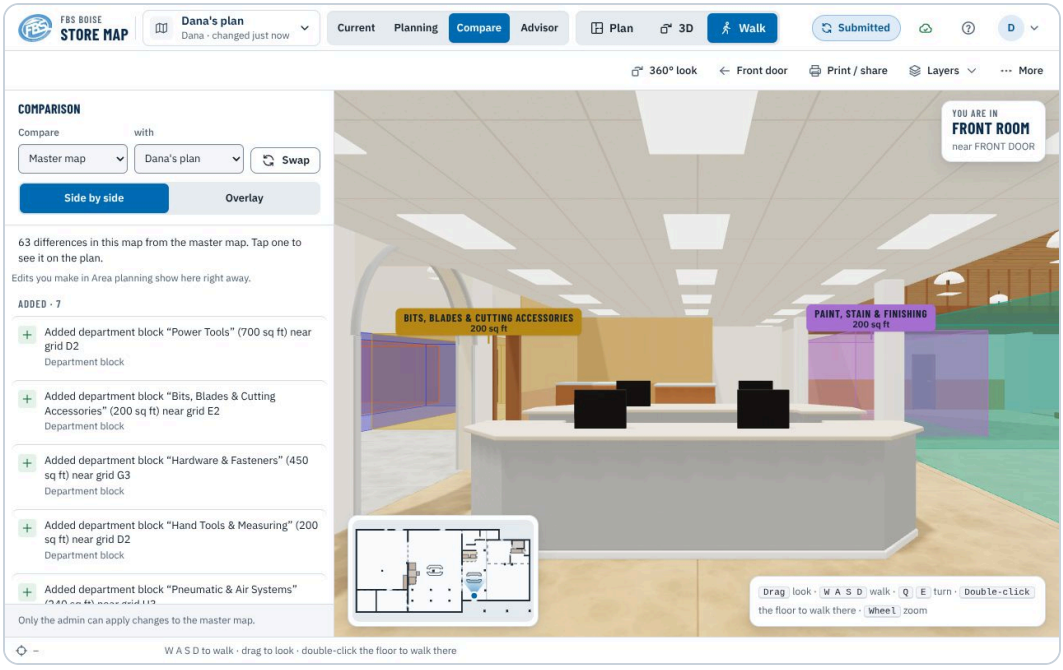
1. Press **Advisor** at the top (or key 4).
2. Read the list from the top: it's sorted with the most important first (**HIGH**, then MEDIUM, then LOW).
3. **Show me** lights up the spot on the map. **Apply** makes the fix for you (you can undo it).
4. Go back to **Planning**, improve, and check again.

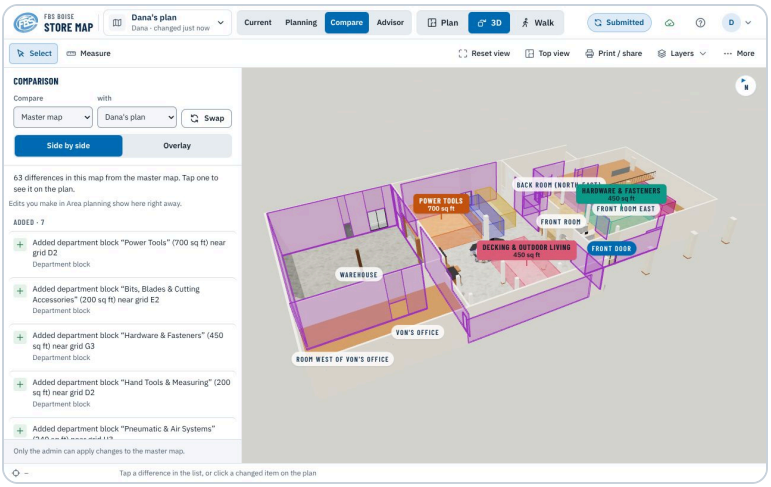


> **Aim for:** no HIGH items left, no red warnings, every department placed and close to its target size. The Advisor can't know everything about our store, so use it as a helper, not the boss.

9. WALK THROUGH IT LIKE A CUSTOMER

Press **Walk** at the top. You stand just inside the front door at eye height. Drag to look around; tap the floor (or double-click) to walk there; on a computer W A S D or the arrow keys walk too. The card in the corner says where you are. Press **3D** to see the whole store from above; drag to turn it, scroll to zoom.

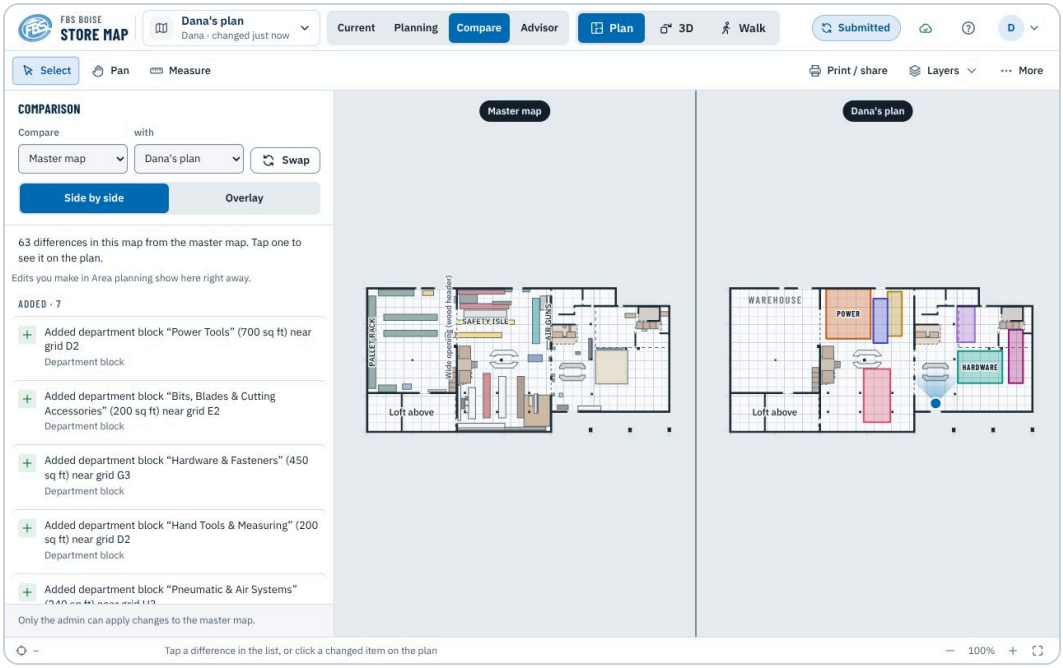




Ask yourself: can I see the most important departments from the door? Is the path to the desks easy?

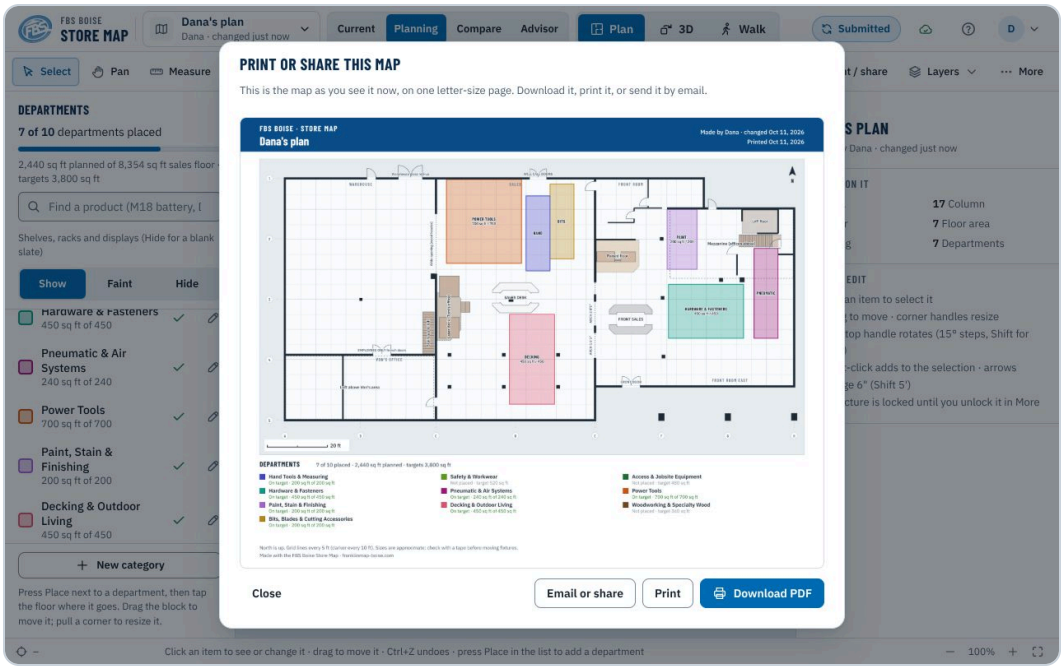
10. COMPARE WITH TODAY'S STORE

Press **Compare** at the top. Today's store (the master map) is on the left and your plan on the right, moving together. The list tells you every difference in plain words, like “Moved ‘Safety isle’ 4' 6" north”. Tap a line to see it on the map. **Overlay** puts the two on top of each other: green = added, grey dashes = removed, blue = moved.



11. PRINT IT, SAVE IT AS A PDF OR EMAIL IT

1. Press **Print / share** at the top right (on a phone: **More** → **Print, PDF or email**).
2. You see the page it will make: the map, the departments and their sizes, on one letter page.
3. **Download PDF** saves the file. **Print** prints it. **Email or share** opens your email (on a phone: the share menu, so you can text it or email it) with the PDF attached.

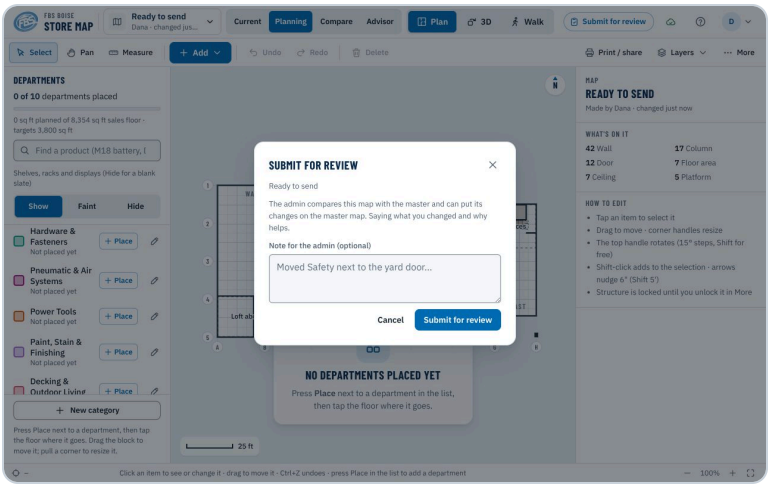




The printed page. It shows what's on your screen, so print from Planning to get your plan.

12. SEND IT TO AJ

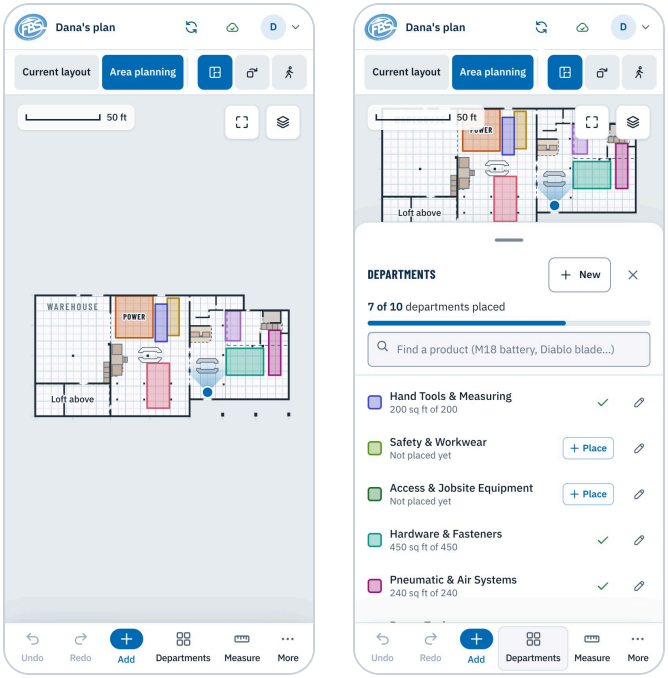
1. When you're happy with your plan, press **Submit for review** at the top.
2. Write a short note about what you changed and why (like “Power tools by the door so people see them first”) and press **Submit for review**.
3. The button now shows where it stands: **Submitted**, then **Approved**, **Needs changes** or **Declined**, with AJ's note. Press it to read the note.



> Your plan stays yours the whole time. You can keep improving it and press **Submit** again, or withdraw it.

13. USING A PHONE

Everything works on a phone. The buttons move to the bottom: **Undo**, **Redo**, **Add**, **Departments**, **Measure** and **More**. Use one finger to select and drag, two fingers to move the map, pinch to zoom. **Departments** opens the list as a sheet you can pull up and down.



14. THE 11 RULES OF A GREAT LAYOUT

These are the same rules the Advisor checks. Use them as your checklist before you send your plan.

Leave room inside the front door	Keep a few open feet just inside the door. People slow down there before they pick a direction.
Put a strong department on the right	Most people turn right after they walk in. The right-hand wall is the most-seen wall in the store.
Put the "must-have" department at the back	Departments people come in for (Hardware & Fasteners) pull them past everything else.
Keep pricey and easy-to-steal items in sight	High-margin and theft-prone departments should be visible from the sales desks and the door.
Bulky stuff near the yard	Heavy, bulky stock (access equipment, decking, pellets) goes near the yard and warehouse doors.
Put related departments together	Things bought together sit together: Bits & Blades next to Power Tools, Paint next to Decking.
Make aisles wide enough	Aisles at least 4 ft, main aisles at least 6 ft, and never narrower than 36 inches (ADA).
No bottlenecks	No narrow spots on the main paths between the front door, the sales desks, will call and the yard doors.
Keep doors and exits clear	Nothing in front of a door, an opening or an exit.
Use quiet corners wisely	Corners far from the main paths get little traffic. Put "must-have" or impulse items there, not pricey ones.
Hit the target sizes	Each department should be close to its target square feet (the list shows it, and turns green when it's right).

THE FASTEST WAY TO A GREAT PLAN

1. Place **every** department first, roughly where you want it, at its target size.
2. Fix every red warning.
3. Open the Advisor and fix the HIGH items. Re-check.
4. Walk through it (Walk view) from the front door.
5. Compare with today's store. Is it really better? Why?
6. Print it and walk the real floor with it. Check the tight spots with a tape measure.
7. Submit it with a clear note.

15. IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- **I made a mistake.** Press Undo (Ctrl+Z). Undo again to go back further.
- **It says “not saved”.** Your changes are kept on your device. Check your internet; it saves as soon as you're back online.
- **I can't move a wall or a column.** They're locked on purpose: More → Structure locked.
- **I can't change the map.** You're on the master map (read-only). Press **Start my own plan**.
- **I got signed out.** Sign in again with your username and password. Your plans are still there.
- **I forgot my password (or my username).** Ask AJ. AJ can see your username and can give you a reset code (section 1).
- **Anything else:** press the **?** at the top for the full list of controls, or ask AJ.

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